

doc-kenoticism-denial

Affirms · Christology › Person · doctrine · divided_lineages · confidence: high

Statement under examination

In the incarnation Christ took on a true human nature without surrendering or giving up the divine attributes proper to His deity.

Rationale

Phil 2:7 (ἐαυτὸν ἐκένωσεν *heauton ekenōsen*, 'he emptied himself', *kenoō* G2758 aorist active indicative 3s) is immediately qualified by *μορφὴν δούλου λαβὼν* (*morphēn doulou labōn*, 'taking the form of a servant', *labōn* G2983 aorist active participle) and *ἐν ὁμοιώματι ἀνθρώπων γενόμενος* ('being born in the likeness of men'), framing the *kenōsis* as ADDITION of human nature, not SUBTRACTION of divine attributes. The same *morphē* G3444 governs v.6 (*en morphē theou*, 'in the form of God') and v.7 (*morphēn doulou*, 'form of a servant'); he TOOK on the second while remaining in the first. Col 2:9 (πᾶν τὸ πλήρωμα τῆς θεότητος σωματικῶς κατοικεῖ, 'the whole fullness of deity dwells bodily', *theotēs* G2320, present-tense *katoikeō* G2730) places the entire divine essence in the incarnate Christ during his bodily incarnate existence, not just before or after. Heb 1:3 (φέρων τε τὰ πάντα τῷ ῥήματι τῆς δυνάμεως αὐτοῦ *pherōn te ta panta tō rēmati tēs dynamēōs autou*, 'upholding the universe by the word of his power', *pherō* G5342 present active participle of continuous action) is asserted of the Son in the incarnational economy of vv.1-4. John 8:58 (ἐγὼ εἰμί), John 10:18 (no one takes my life from me, I lay it down of my own accord, *exousia* G1849), and Matt 11:27 (no one knows the Father except the Son, *epignōskō* G1921) display divine prerogatives exercised during the earthly mission. The strong kenoticist claim that Christ subtracted divine attributes during the incarnation collapses on Col 2:9 alone, which fixes the divine fullness in him *sōmatikōs* ('bodily', i.e. in his incarnate body), and is then doubled by Heb 1:3 and the canonical pattern.

Reasoning

Verdict: when Jesus became human, he added a true human nature to his eternal divine nature; he did not give up being God. He was fully God and fully human at the same time during his earthly life. The strongest reason from Scripture is Colossians 2:9, where Paul writes that in Christ 'the whole fullness of deity dwells bodily.' The word 'dwells' is a present-tense verb, and the word 'bodily' means in his physical body. Paul is saying that the complete divine nature lives in the incarnate Jesus, in his body, right then. Hebrews 1:3 adds that the Son is 'upholding the universe by the word of his power,' which he could not do if he had given up his divine power. Philippians 2:7, which says Jesus 'emptied himself,' immediately explains how: 'by taking the form of a servant, being born in the likeness of men.' The emptying is an adding of human nature, not a subtracting of divine nature. The strongest counterargument inside the Bible is the set of passages where Jesus appears limited. Mark 13:32 says even the Son does not know the day or the hour. Luke 2:52 says Jesus grew in wisdom. John 4:6 says he was tired and thirsty. Critics argue that if he was fully God, he could not be limited like this. The historic Christian answer is that Jesus has two natures, one divine and one human, united in one person. He experienced human limitations through his human nature without ever ceasing to be fully God in his divine nature. He could be tired and also be the one upholding the universe. He could choose not to exercise omniscience without losing it. Philippians 2:7 is read with Colossians 2:9 to hold both truths together. The Bible does not say he stopped being God when he became a man.

Denominational landscape

All major historic Christian lineages reject strong kenoticism, the view that Christ literally divested divine attributes during his earthly life. The Chalcedonian Definition of AD 451 confesses Christ as one person in two natures, divine and human, 'without confusion, change, division, or separation,' which directly excludes any subtraction of divine attributes at the incarnation. Patristic authors who developed this doctrine include Athanasius, Cyril of Alexandria, Leo the Great, and John of Damascus. The Catholic Catechism teaches that the eternal Son took on a human nature without ceasing to be true God. The Lutheran Book of Concord teaches the *communicatio idiomatum*, the communication of attributes, in which the divine and human properties belong to the one person Christ, with Lutherans distinctively affirming the *genus maiestaticum* (the human nature shares in divine majesty), the very opposite of kenotic subtraction. The Anglican 39 Articles, Article 2, confess Christ as 'very God and very man' in one person. The Reformed confessions, including Westminster Confession 8.2, affirm that Christ remained 'very and eternal God' even while taking on man's nature. Methodists in their Articles of Religion repeat the Anglican formula. Anabaptists at Dordrecht confess the eternal Son. Pentecostals in the Assemblies of God affirm classical Christology. Eastern Orthodoxy holds the Chalcedonian formula at the center of its faith. Public-record carriers of strong kenoticism are minority figures. The 19th-century German kenoticists Gottfried Thomasius, F. H. R. Frank, and W. F. Gess taught that the Son truly subtracted divine attributes at the incarnation, with Gess pushing the view furthest. Charles Gore in his Bampton Lectures of 1891 held a moderated form. Frank Weston, the Anglican bishop of Zanzibar, articulated a strong kenotic view in *The One Christ* in 1907. H. R. Mackintosh defended the doctrine in *The Doctrine of the Person of Jesus Christ* in 1912. These views were never carried by a major confessing tradition; they remain in-house theological proposals rejected as compromising the Chalcedonian two-natures doctrine. They are heterodox by ecumenical standards but are not classified as cults; they affirm the eternal deity of the Son before the incarnation and after the resurrection, and they affirm the personal identity of Jesus as the divine Son. The cult-marker line sits at outright denial of Christ's deity overall, which strong kenoticism does not technically cross.

Position thresholds

Would die for if challenged	Yes
Cult marker if denied	No
Would visit if otherwise	Yes
Would participate if otherwise	No
Would serve if otherwise	No
Would be member if otherwise	No
Would let children be taught otherwise	No
Would marry if held otherwise	No
Would publicly correct if otherwise	Yes

Notes

Strong kenoticism (the view that Christ literally divested divine attributes such as omniscience, omnipresence, and omnipotence during his earthly life, so that he was not fully God between the incarnation and the resurrection) is heterodox by Chalcedonian standards but is not classified as a gospel-denying cult marker by most ecumenical conventions. The cult-marker line sits at full denial of Christ's deity overall (handled separately by *doc-christ-full-deity*), which strong kenoticism does not technically cross because it affirms the Son's eternal deity before and after the incarnation. Public-record carriers of the strong form: Gottfried Thomasius and the 19th-century German kenoticists (Thomasius,

Frank, Gess) who taught that the Son truly relinquished the relative divine attributes at the incarnation; Charles Gore in his Bampton Lectures of 1891 in some moods, though Gore is contested; Frank Weston, the early-20th-century Anglican bishop of Zanzibar in his work on the kenōsis (The One Christ); H. R. Mackintosh in The Doctrine of the Person of Jesus Christ. Most evangelical preachers who use 'kenosis language' do not actually hold strong kenoticism; they teach the qualified-prerogative kenosis (the Son voluntarily restrained the independent exercise of divine attributes while retaining the attributes themselves), which is what Phil 2:7 read with Col 2:9 actually supports and which this question affirms. Fruit-vs-precision nuance is substantial: a believer who says Jesus 'gave up his divine powers to become a man' often means the qualified form even when their words sound like the strong form, and gentle clarification rather than rupture is the appropriate response. The verdict denies strong kenoticism, would die for full deity throughout the incarnation as anchored in Col 2:9 and Heb 1:3, but would not classify strong kenoticism as a cult; it is a Christological error that compromises the orthodox two-natures doctrine without crossing into outright denial of Christ's deity.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: no

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play. classical_chalcedonian, strong_kenoticism, qualified_kenosis, lutheran_communicatio_idiomatum

analogia scripturae invoked

Competing lens verdicts

· affirms:

· denies:

· affirms:

· affirms:

The verdict rests on a pan-canonical lemma network. The kenōsis-language of Phil 2:7 (ekenōsen, kenoō G2758) is immediately defined by the two participles labōn G2983 ('taking') and genomenos G1096 ('becoming'), which frame the action as addition of human nature, not subtraction of divine attribute. Col 2:9 (the whole fullness of deity dwells bodily, present-tense katoikei) directly contradicts strong-kenoticist subtraction. Heb 1:3 (the Son upholding the universe by the word of his power, present-tense pherōn) and Col 1:17 (in him all things hold together, perfect-tense synestēken) maintain cosmic divine activity during the incarnational economy. The earthly-ministry expressions of divine prerogative (John 8:58 egō eimi, John 16:30 he knows all things, John 10:18 sovereign exousia over his own life, Matt 11:27 reciprocal divine knowing) display attributes actively exercised in the incarnate state. Analogia scripturae is invoked at the complicating texts (Mark 13:32 not-knowing the hour, Luke 2:52 growth in wisdom, John 4:6 weariness, John 11:35 weeping), which are integrated through the two-natures framework without requiring divine-attribute subtraction. Progressive revelation does not factor; the question is settled within the New Testament corpus. No non-default hermeneutic is required; grammatico-historical method on the canon suffices.

Scripture (apparatus + interlinear)

Phil.2.6 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. ἐν μορφῇ θεοῦ ὑπάρχων οὐχ ἄρπαγμόν ἡγήσατο τὸ εἶναι ἴσα θεῷ; morphē G3444; hyparchō G5225 present active participle; harpagmos G725; isos G2470

Force. 'Who, though he was in the form of God, did not count equality with God a thing to be grasped.' morphē denotes essential form, not external appearance. Hyparchōn is a present participle of continuous prior existence: he was and continued to be in the divine form. To einai isa theō (the being equal with God) is what he already possessed. The frame of v.6 establishes the starting point of the kenōsis as full divine equality.

Phil.2.7 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. ἐαυτὸν ἐκένωσεν μορφὴν δούλου λαβὼν ἐν ὁμοιώματι ἀνθρώπων γενόμενος; kenoō G2758 aorist active indicative 3s; morphē G3444; doulos G1401; lambanō G2983 aorist active participle; homoiōma G3667; ginomai G1096 aorist middle participle

Force. 'But emptied himself, by taking the form of a servant, being born in the likeness of men.' The kenōsis is immediately defined by two parallel participles: labōn ('taking') the form of a servant, and genomenos ('becoming') in the likeness of men. The emptying is not a subtraction of what he had but an addition of what he did not have. The same morphē governs v.6 (form of God) and v.7 (form of a servant), framing the incarnation as the assumption of a second mode of existence, not the surrender of the first. Kenoō elsewhere in Paul (Rom 4:14, 1 Cor 1:17, 9:15, 2 Cor 9:3) means 'render void, of no effect', but the Phil 2:7 sense is explicated by the participles, not by lexicon alone.

Col.2.9 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. ἐν αὐτῷ κατοικεῖ πᾶν τὸ πλήρωμα τῆς θεότητος σωματικῶς; katoikeō G2730 present active indicative 3s; plērōma G4138; theotēs G2320; sōmatikōs G4985

Force. 'For in him the whole fullness of deity dwells bodily.' Theotēs G2320 is the abstract noun for the divine nature itself, distinct from theiotēs G2305 (divine quality, Rom 1:20); theotēs carries the full essence-content. Plērōma modified by pan leaves nothing of the divine nature outside Christ. Sōmatikōs locates this fullness in his incarnate body. The present-tense katoikei (continuous dwelling) places this during the time the epistle is written, after the incarnation, with the natural canonical reading extending through the incarnate life. Decisive against strong kenoticism: if Christ subtracted divine attributes at the incarnation, the whole fullness of deity did not dwell bodily in him during that period.

Heb.1.3 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. φέρων τε τὰ πάντα τῷ ῥήματι τῆς δυνάμεως αὐτοῦ; pherō G5342 present active participle; pas G3956; rhēma G4487; dynamis G1411

Force. 'He upholds the universe by the word of his power.' Pherōn is a present-tense participle of continuous action. The author of Hebrews predicates this of the Son in the very passage (vv.1-4) that narrates the Son's incarnational mission and exaltation. If the Son had subtracted omnipotence at the incarnation, he could not be upholding the universe by the word of his power during it. The text gives no indication of a hiatus in this cosmic sustaining activity during the incarnation. Against strong kenoticism.

John.1.14 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. ὁ λόγος σὰρξ ἐγένετο καὶ ἐσκήνωσεν ἐν ἡμῖν; sarx G4561; ginomai G1096 aorist middle indicative 3s; skēnoō G4637 aorist active indicative 3s; doxa G1391; monogenēs G3439

Force. 'And the Word became flesh and dwelt among us, and we have seen his glory, glory as of the only Son from the Father, full of grace and truth.' Ginomai of the incarnation does not require subtraction; the Word, who was God (1:1), became flesh. Doxa (glory) is the same word used of YHWH's Shekinah in the LXX; the disciples beheld this glory during the earthly ministry (cf. 2:11, Cana; the Transfiguration in the Synoptics). The divine glory was visible in the incarnate Christ, not stored away.

John.8.58 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. πρὶν Ἀβραὰμ γενέσθαι ἐγὼ εἰμί; egō eimi G1473 plus G1510 present indicative active 1s; ginomai G1096 aorist middle infinitive

Force. 'Before Abraham was, I am.' Jesus contrasts the aoristic ginomai of Abraham with the present absolute eimi of his own divine self-existence, in echo of Exod 3:14. He speaks this during his earthly ministry, exercising divine self-naming in the incarnate state. If he had divested divine self-knowledge or eternal pre-existence at the incarnation, this self-naming would be impossible.

John.10.18 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. οὐδεὶς αἶρει αὐτὴν ἀπ' ἐμοῦ ἀλλ' ἐγὼ τίθημι αὐτὴν ἀπ' ἑαυτοῦ ἐξουσίαν ἔχω; airō G142; tithēmi G5087; exousia G1849

Force. 'No one takes it from me, but I lay it down of my own accord. I have authority to lay it down, and I have authority to take it up again.' Jesus claims exousia (sovereign authority) over his own life and death, an exclusively divine prerogative. Spoken during the earthly mission. He exercises sovereign authority while incarnate, not in spite of being incarnate.

Matt.11.27 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. οὐδεὶς ἐπιγινώσκει τὸν υἱὸν εἰ μὴ ὁ πατήρ οὐδὲ τὸν πατέρα τις ἐπιγινώσκει εἰ μὴ ὁ υἱός; epignōskō G1921 present active indicative 3s; huios G5207; patēr G3962

Force. 'No one knows the Son except the Father, and no one knows the Father except the Son.' Reciprocal divine knowledge between Father and Son, asserted of the Son during the earthly mission. The verb epignōskō denotes full and exhaustive knowledge. If the Son had subtracted omniscience at the incarnation, he could not be in this reciprocal divine knowing relation with the Father during it.

John.2.24 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. αὐτὸς δὲ Ἰησοῦς οὐκ ἐπίστευεν αὐτὸν αὐτοῖς διὰ τὸ αὐτὸν γινώσκειν πάντας; ginōskō G1097 present active infinitive; pas G3956

Force. 'But Jesus on his part did not entrust himself to them, because he knew all people.' During the earthly ministry, Jesus is said to know all people (pantas). Cf. John 16:30, where the disciples confess 'now we know that you know all things'. Divine knowledge exercised in the incarnate state, against strong kenoticism's claim that omniscience was subtracted.

John.16.30 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. νῦν οἶδμεν ὅτι οἶδας πάντα; oida G1492 perfect active indicative 2s; pas G3956

Force. 'Now we know that you know all things.' The disciples confess of the incarnate Jesus that he knows all things (panta). Oida in the perfect with present force ('you know'). Against strong kenoticism's omniscience-subtraction.

Col.1.17 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. καὶ αὐτὸς ἐστὶν πρὸ πάντων καὶ τὰ πάντα ἐν αὐτῷ συνέστηκεν; pro G4253; synistēmi G4921 perfect active indicative 3s

Force. 'And he is before all things, and in him all things hold together.' Synistēmi in the perfect ('have held and still hold together') of cosmic sustaining. Paul predicates this of the Son in the same Christ-hymn frame that climaxes at Col 2:9. Continuous cosmic sustaining during the incarnational economy.

Mark.13.32 · complicates · genre: gospel

Key term. περὶ δὲ τῆς ἡμέρας ἐκείνης ἢ τῆς ὥρας οὐδεὶς οἶδεν οὐδὲ ὁ υἱός; oida G1492 perfect active indicative 3s; huiois G5207

Force. 'But concerning that day or that hour, no one knows, not even the angels in heaven, nor the Son, but only the Father.' Read flatly as ontological omniscience-subtraction, this would support strong kenoticism. Read with Col 2:9, Heb 1:3, John 16:30, and Matt 11:27, the Son's not-knowing is predicated of his human nature during the earthly mission, while his divine omniscience is preserved (the two-natures framework). The verse complicates the verdict but does not overturn it; the canonical witness fixes the reading.

Luke.2.52 · complicates · genre: gospel

Key term. καὶ Ἰησοῦς προέκοπτεν σοφία καὶ ἡλικία; prokoptō G4298 imperfect active indicative 3s; sophia G4678; hēlikia G2244

Force. 'And Jesus increased in wisdom and stature.' Prokoptō (imperfect of progressive action) of growth in sophia. Read flatly, would support strong kenoticism. Read with John 2:24 and John 16:30, the growth is predicated of his human nature; the divine omniscience is preserved. Two-natures framework integrates the data without subtraction.

John.4.6 · complicates · genre: gospel

Key term. ὁ οὖν Ἰησοῦς κεκοπιακῶς ἐκ τῆς ὁδοιπορίας; kopiaō G2872 perfect active participle; hodoiporia G3597

Force. 'Jesus, wearied as he was from his journey, was sitting beside the well.' Predicates human exhaustion of Jesus. Read flatly, would support strong kenoticism. Read with Heb 1:3 and Col 1:17, the weariness is predicated of his human nature; the divine sustaining of the universe is preserved through the same person. The two-natures framework integrates the limitation without divine-attribute subtraction.

John.11.35 · complicates · genre: gospel

Key term. ἐδάκρυσεν ὁ Ἰησοῦς; dakryō G1145 aorist active indicative 3s

Force. 'Jesus wept.' Predicates human emotion and grief of Jesus. Read flatly, would support kenotic subtraction of impassibility. Read with the two-natures framework, the weeping is predicated of his human nature; the divine nature is not literally compromised. Anthropopathism in the strict sense does not apply to the incarnate Christ (he genuinely had a human soul), but the impassibility question is integrated through the two natures, not through divine-attribute subtraction.

John.17.5 · complicates · genre: gospel

Key term. δόξασόν με σύ πάτερ παρὰ σεαυτῷ τῇ δόξῃ ἣ εἶχον πρὸ τοῦ τὸν κόσμον εἶναι παρὰ σοί; doxa G1391; echō G2192 imperfect active indicative 1s

Force. 'Glorify me in your own presence with the glory that I had with you before the world existed.' Jesus prays for the restoration of the visible exercise of pre-incarnate glory. The imperfect eichon ('I had') governs doxa (glory). Read with strong kenoticism, this could be cited for divine-attribute restoration after a subtraction. Read with John 1:14 (the disciples beheld his glory during the incarnation), the prayer asks for the public manifestation of glory restrained during the earthly mission, not for re-acquisition of attributes lost. Complicates the verdict but does not overturn it; the qualified-prerogative kenosis reading (restraint of independent exercise, not subtraction of attribute) integrates John 17:5 with Col 2:9.

John.1.18 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. μονογενῆς θεὸς ὁ ὢν εἰς τὸν κόλπον τοῦ πατρὸς; monogenēs G3439; theos G2316; ho ōn

Force. 'No one has ever seen God; the only God, who is at the Father's side, has made him known.' The participle ho ōn ('the one who is') is present-tense. John writes after the incarnation about the Son who, during his earthly mission, was at the Father's side. The incarnate Son did not vacate the Father's bosom. Against strong kenoticism.

John.3.13 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. οὐδείς ἀναβέβηκεν εἰς τὸν οὐρανὸν εἰ μὴ ὁ ἐκ τοῦ οὐρανοῦ καταβάς ὁ υἱὸς τοῦ ἀνθρώπου; anabainō G305 perfect active indicative 3s; katabainō G2597 aorist active participle

Force. 'No one has ascended into heaven except he who descended from heaven, the Son of Man.' Several manuscripts add 'who is in heaven' (ho ōn en tō ouranō), present participle, indicating that during his earthly conversation with Nicodemus the Son of Man is simultaneously in heaven. Even without the disputed addition, the descent-language presupposes ongoing divine presence. Against strong kenoticism's spatial-attribute subtraction.

Matt.28.18 · for · genre: gospel

Key term. ἐδόθη μοι πᾶσα ἐξουσία ἐν οὐρανῷ καὶ ἐπὶ γῆς; didōmi G1325 aorist passive indicative 3s; exousia G1849; pas G3956

Force. 'All authority in heaven and on earth has been given to me.' Spoken by the risen but still incarnate Christ. Universal exousia. The post-resurrection state shows the Son fully exercising what strong kenoticism claims was subtracted. The risen Christ remains incarnate (Luke 24:39, 'a spirit does not have flesh and bones as you see that I have'), so the divine prerogatives are exercised in the incarnate state.

Heb.13.8 · for · genre: epistle

Key term. Ἰησοῦς Χριστὸς ἔχθες καὶ σήμερον ὁ αὐτὸς καὶ εἰς τοὺς αἰῶνας; autos G846; aiōn G165

Force. 'Jesus Christ is the same yesterday and today and forever.' Immutability of the person of Christ across all time. Strong kenoticism requires Christ to be ontologically different (lacking divine attributes) during the incarnation than before or after, which contradicts Heb 13:8 read in canonical context with Mal 3:6 (the divine 'I, YHWH, do not change'). Christ as God does not subtract or alter his divine nature.

Concordance lemmas traversed

G2758, G3444, G1401, G2983, G3667, G1096, G5225, G725, G2470, G2316, G4138, G2320, G2305, G4985, G2730, G5342, G3956, G4487, G1411, G4561, G4637, G1391, G3439, G1473, G1510, G142, G5087, G1849, G1921, G5207, G3962, G1097, G1492, G4253, G4921, G4298, G4678, G2244, G2872, G3597, G1145, G2192, G305, G2597, G1325, G846, G165

complicating texts searched: Yes

Counter-witness traditions

patristic · Athanasius, De Decretis (NPNF2-04); Cyril of Alexandria, On the Unity of Christ; Chalcedonian Definition AD 451 (NPNF2-14); John of Damascus, Exposition of the Orthodox Faith Book III · affirms · verified

"Chalcedon: one and the same Christ, recognized in two natures, 'without confusion, change, division, or separation', the distinction of natures being in no way annulled by the union. Excludes divine-attribute subtraction at the incarnation"

catholic_magisterial · Catechism of the Catholic Church paragraphs 464 to 469 on Christ true God and true man (vatican.va) · affirms · unverified

“CCC 464: 'The unique and altogether singular event of the Incarnation of the Son of God does not mean that Jesus Christ is part God and part man, nor does it imply that he is the result of a confused mixture of the divine and the human.' CCC 469: He is true God and true man”

lutheran · Formula of Concord, Solid Declaration VIII, Of the Person of Christ (bookofconcord.org); Augsburg Confession Article III · affirms · unverified

“Formula of Concord SD VIII teaches the communicatio idiomatum and the genus maiestaticum: the human nature shares in divine majesty in the personal union. The opposite of kenotic subtraction; Lutheran Christology maximizes attribute-sharing”

anglican · 39 Articles, Article II, Of the Word or Son of God, which was made very Man (churchofengland.org) · affirms · unverified

“Article II: 'The Son, which is the Word of the Father, begotten from everlasting of the Father, the very and eternal God, and of one substance with the Father, took Man's nature in the womb of the blessed Virgin'. Two natures, no divine-attribute subtraction”

reformed · Westminster Confession of Faith 8.2; Belgic Confession Article 19; Heidelberg Catechism Q&A 35-36 · affirms · unverified

“WCF 8.2: 'The Son of God, the second person in the Trinity, being very and eternal God, of one substance and equal with the Father, did, when the fullness of time was come, take upon him man's nature, with all the essential properties and common infirmities thereof, yet without sin”

methodist · United Methodist Articles of Religion, Article II, Of the Word, or Son of God, Who Was Made Very Man (umc.org) · affirms · unverified

“The Son, who is the Word of the Father, the very and eternal God, of one substance with the Father, took man's nature in the womb of the blessed Virgin.' Wesley's abridgement of Article II preserves the Chalcedonian substance”

anabaptist · Dordrecht Confession 1632 Article 3, Of the Restoration of Man through the Promise of the Coming of Christ · affirms · unverified

“Dordrecht confesses the eternal Son sent by the Father, born of Mary, the true Messiah. The Anabaptist mainstream affirmed Chalcedonian Christology; Menno Simons's celestial-flesh views were a minority and were corrected within the Anabaptist tradition”

pentecostal · Assemblies of God Statement of Fundamental Truths, Truth 3, The Deity of the Lord Jesus Christ (ag.org) · affirms · unverified

“AG Truth 3 affirms the deity of Christ, virgin birth, sinless life, miraculous ministry, substitutionary atonement, bodily resurrection. The classical Chalcedonian frame is preserved; no divine-attribute subtraction at the incarnation”

eastern_orthodox · OCA, The Orthodox Faith, Doctrine and Scripture, on Jesus Christ (oca.org); the Nicene-Constantinopolitan Creed in the Divine Liturgy; John of Damascus, Exposition of the Orthodox Faith · affirms · verified

“Orthodoxy holds the Chalcedonian two-natures formula. The Son took on human nature without ceasing to be true God. Orthodox theology emphasizes that the divine nature is impassible and unchangeable; what suffers and grows is the human nature in the personal union”

Web sources

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/philippians/2-7.htm>

“Phil 2:7 'heauton ekenōsen morphēn doulou labōn'. kenoō G2758 aorist; defined immediately by labōn (taking) and genomenos (becoming). Kenōsis is addition of the form of a servant, not subtraction of divine attribute”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/strongs/greek/2758.htm>

“kenoō G2758, 'to empty, render void'. Used elsewhere by Paul of nullifying faith (Rom 4:14) or boasting (1 Cor 9:15). The Phil 2:7 sense is defined by the participles, not by lexicon alone; the context is self-humbling by addition”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/strongs/greek/3444.htm>

“morphē G3444. Essential form denoting the true nature of a thing, not its external shape. Governs both Phil 2:6 (form of God) and 2:7 (form of a servant), framing the kenōsis as the assumption of a second mode of existence”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/colossians/2-9.htm>

“Col 2:9 'en autō katoikei pan to plērōma tēs theotētos sōmatikōs'. theotēs G2320 abstract divine nature; pan to plērōma leaves nothing of deity outside Christ; sōmatikōs locates this in his incarnate body; present-tense katoikei. Decisive against strong kenoticism”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/strongs/greek/2320.htm>

“theotēs G2320, NT hapax at Col 2:9. Abstract noun for the divine nature itself, distinguished from theiotēs G2305 ('divine quality', Rom 1:20). Carries the full essence-content of deity”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/hebrews/1-3.htm>

“Heb 1:3 'pherōn te ta panta tō rēmati tēs dymameōs autou'. pherōn G5342 present active participle of continuous action. The Son upholds the universe during the same passage that narrates his incarnational mission. Against strong kenoticism's omnipotence-subtraction”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/john/8-58.htm>

“John 8:58 'prin Abraam genesthai egō eimi'. Jesus speaks egō eimi during his earthly ministry, echoing Exod 3:14. Divine self-naming exercised in the incarnate state, against kenotic subtraction”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/john/10-18.htm>

“John 10:18 'exousia echō theinai autēn'. exousia G1849 of sovereign authority over his own life and death. An exclusively divine prerogative exercised during the earthly mission”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/matthew/11-27.htm>

“Matt 11:27 'oudeis epiginōskei ton huion ei mē ho patēr oude ton patera tis epiginōskei ei mē ho huiois'. epignōskō G1921 of exhaustive reciprocal divine knowing between Father and Son, asserted during the earthly mission”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/john/16-30.htm>

“John 16:30 'nyn oidamen hoti oidas panta'. The disciples confess that the incarnate Jesus knows all things (panta). Against strong kenoticism's omniscience-subtraction”

supports · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/colossians/1-17.htm>

“Col 1:17 'kai ta panta en autō synestēken'. synistēmi G4921 perfect with present force. In Christ all things have held and still hold together. Continuous cosmic sustaining during the incarnational economy”

complicates · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/mark/13-32.htm>

“Mark 13:32 'oude ho huiois'. The Son does not know the day or the hour. Flat reading supports omniscience-subtraction; canonical reading predicates the not-knowing of the human nature while divine omniscience is preserved in the same person”

complicates · category: interlinear · <https://biblehub.com/interlinear/luke/2-52.htm>

“Luke 2:52 'Iēsous proekopten sophia'. prokoptō G4298 imperfect of progressive growth in wisdom. Predicated of his human nature; the two-natures framework integrates without divine-attribute subtraction”

supports · category: magisterial · https://www.vatican.va/archive/ENG0015/___P21.HTM

“CCC on the Incarnation: Christ is true God and true man, not a mixture of the two natures. The eternal Son took on a complete human nature without ceasing to be true God. Excludes divine-attribute subtraction”

supports · category: tradition_primary ·

<https://bookofconcord.org/formula-of-concord-solid-declaration/of-the-person-of-christ/>

“Formula of Concord Solid Declaration VIII teaches the communicatio idiomatum and the genus maiestaticum. The human nature shares in divine majesty in the personal union. The opposite of kenotic subtraction”

supports · category: tradition_primary ·

<https://www.oca.org/orthodoxy/the-orthodox-faith/doctrine-scripture/the-symbol-of-faith/jesus-christ>

“OCA on Jesus Christ: the eternal Son took on human nature without ceasing to be true God. Divine nature is impassible and unchangeable; what suffers and grows is the human nature in the personal union”

supports · category: tradition_primary ·

<https://www.churchofengland.org/prayer-and-worship/worship-texts-and-resources/book-common-prayer/articles-religion>

“39 Articles, Article II: 'The Son, which is the Word of the Father, begotten from everlasting of the Father, the very and eternal God, and of one substance with the Father, took Man's nature in the womb of the blessed Virgin'”